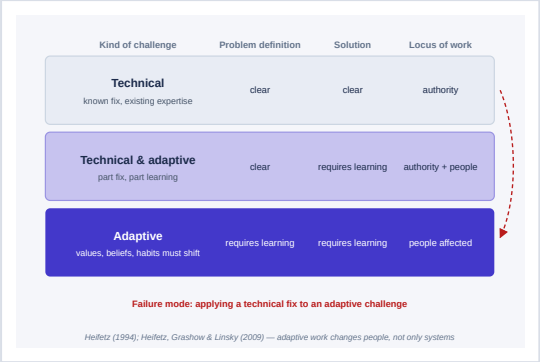
Unit 4 Frameworks

8 frameworks from Slibrary 7 to 8, each with its figure, Harvard reference, a note on the author(s) and the guiding question for the Valcortese Dairy case.

Slibrary 7 — Adaptive Leadership Under Uncertainty

4 frameworks



F25 · Slibrary 7 · Sheet 1/4

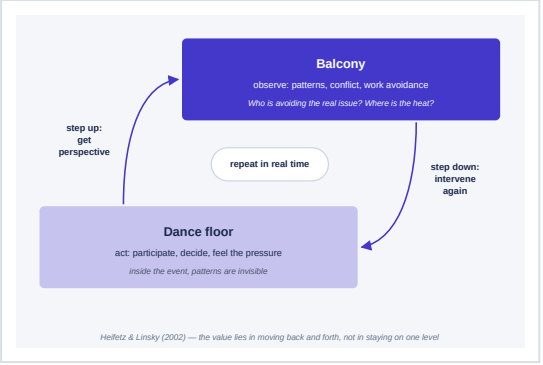
Technical vs. Adaptive Challenges

Can experts fix it — or must the people with the problem change?

Source (Harvard): Heifetz, R.A. (1994) Leadership Without Easy Answers. Cambridge, MA: Belknap Press of Harvard University Press.

In one sentence	Some problems can be fixed by experts with known solutions; adaptive challenges require the people involved to learn and change habits, values or priorities — and mistaking one for the other is a classic leadership failure.
About the author(s)	Ronald A. Heifetz trained in medicine and psychiatry and co-founded the Center for Public Leadership at Harvard Kennedy School, where he teaches adaptive leadership. With Marty Linsky and Alexander Grashow he co-founded the consultancy Cambridge Leadership Associates.
Guiding question (Valcortese Dairy case)	*At Valcortese the head of production wants new sensors and a dismissed supervisor, yet 61 of 63 alerts were false and targets rose by 8%: which parts of the crisis are technical, which are adaptive, and who must do the adaptive work?*

© 2026 Dr. Hildegard Haas · EU Business School · MASCO201 · Unit 4 framework reference



F26 · Slibrary 7 · Sheet 2/4

Balcony and Dance Floor

Step back to see the system, step in to act

Source (Harvard): Heifetz, R.A. and Linsky, M. (2002) Leadership on the Line: Staying Alive through the Dangers of Leading. Boston, MA: Harvard Business School Press.

In one sentence	Good leaders keep switching between acting in the middle of events and stepping back to watch them, so that they see the patterns, conflicts and avoidance that are invisible from inside the action.
About the author(s)	Ronald A. Heifetz co-founded the Center for Public Leadership at Harvard Kennedy School, where he teaches adaptive leadership. Marty Linsky, a former journalist and Massachusetts state official, taught at Harvard Kennedy School for many years and co-founded Cambridge Leadership Associates.
Guiding question (Valcortese Dairy case)	*In Valcortese's Saturday crisis meeting three proposals compete before the 12:00 deadline: if Marco stepped onto the balcony for five minutes, which pattern among production, the board and the agency would he see?*



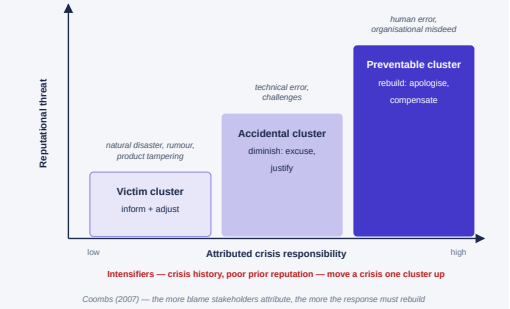
F27 · Slibrary 7 · Sheet 3/4

Cynefin for Leaders

Match how you decide to the kind of situation you face

Source (Harvard): Snowden, D.J. and Boone, M.E. (2007) 'A leader's framework for decision making', Harvard Business Review, 85(11), pp. 68-76.

In one sentence	Situations fall into simple, complicated, complex or chaotic domains, and each needs a different way of deciding; in a crisis a leader must first act to stabilise before experimenting or analysing.
About the author(s)	Dave Snowden is a Welsh management consultant and researcher who founded Cognitive Edge, now The Cynefin Company. Mary E. Boone was president of Boone Associates, a consultancy in Essex, Connecticut, and wrote on leadership and communication.
Guiding question (Valcortese Dairy case)	*On Friday evening at Valcortese, 18,000 units are in shops and two Austrian illness reports are unconfirmed: which Cynefin domain is Marco in, what must he do first, and when does the situation become complex?*



F28 · Slibrary 7 · Sheet 4/4

Situational Crisis Communication Theory

The more blame stakeholders attribute, the more you must rebuild

Source (Harvard): Coombs, W.T. (2007) 'Protecting organization reputations during a crisis: the development and application of situational crisis communication theory', Corporate Reputation Review, 10(3), pp. 163-176.

In one sentence	How an organisation should respond to a crisis depends on how much blame stakeholders give it: victims inform and care, accidents explain, and preventable crises require apology and compensation.
About the author(s)	W. Timothy Coombs is a professor of communication at Texas A&M University and one of the most cited researchers in crisis communication. His books include Ongoing Crisis Communication, and his early tests of the theory were co-authored with Sherry J. Holladay.
Guiding question (Valcortese Dairy case)	*Valcortese's chair wants 'purely precautionary', yet two real AI alerts were overridden nine days earlier: which cluster will stakeholders assign once that is known, and what must the statement due by Saturday 12:00 therefore contain?*

Slibrary 8 — AI Slibrary · Algorithmic Decision Support

4 frameworks



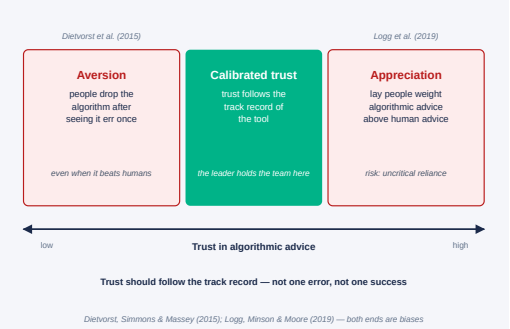
F29 · Slibrary 8 · Sheet 1/4

Levels of Automation

Set the machine's role stage by stage, not all at once

Source (Harvard): Parasuraman, R., Sheridan, T.B. and Wickens, C.D. (2000) 'A model for types and levels of human interaction with automation', IEEE Transactions on Systems, Man, and Cybernetics - Part A: Systems and Humans, 30(3), pp. 286-297.

In one sentence	Automation is not all-or-nothing: gathering information, analysing it, choosing a decision and acting on it can each be automated to a different degree, and leaders should decide deliberately where humans stay in charge.
About the author(s)	Raja Parasuraman was a leading researcher on human–automation interaction. Thomas B. Sheridan, Professor Emeritus at MIT, pioneered research on supervisory control; Christopher D. Wickens is known for his multiple-resource theory of attention and his textbooks on engineering psychology.
Guiding question (Valcortese Dairy case)	*At Valcortese the AI flagged the cooling-line anomaly, but a supervisor overrode it after a month of 61 false alerts: at which stage did the human–machine design fail, and what level of automation would you now set for each stage?*



F30 · Slibrary 8 · Sheet 2/4

Algorithm Aversion and Appreciation

Trust in algorithms swings too far — calibrate it to the record

Source (Harvard): Dietvorst, B.J., Simmons, J.P. and Massey, C. (2015) 'Algorithm aversion: people erroneously avoid algorithms after seeing them err', Journal of Experimental Psychology: General, 144(1), pp. 114-126; Logg, J.M., Minson, J.A. and Moore, D.A. (2019) 'Algorithm appreciation: people prefer algorithmic to human judgment', Organizational Behavior and Human Decision Processes, 151, pp. 90-103.

In one sentence	People either abandon an algorithm after seeing it make one mistake or follow its advice too readily; leaders should help their teams base trust on the tool's actual track record.
About the author(s)	Berkeley J. Dietvorst is at the University of Chicago Booth School of Business; Joseph P. Simmons and Cade Massey are at the Wharton School. Jennifer M. Logg is at Georgetown University's McDonough School of Business; Julia A. Minson is at Harvard Kennedy School and Don A. Moore at UC Berkeley.
Guiding question (Valcortese Dairy case)	*Valcortese's supervisors called the system 'the sensor that cries wolf' after 61 false alerts in one month: is this algorithm aversion, and how would Marco rebuild calibrated trust without ordering them to obey every alert?*



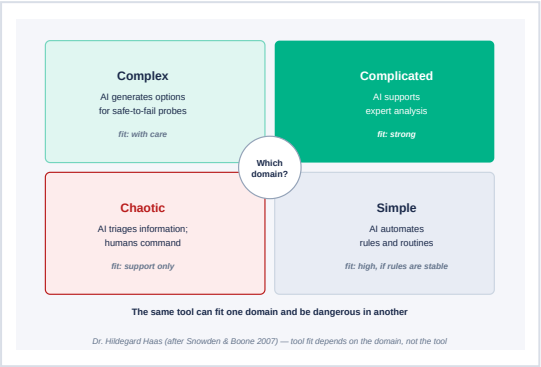
F31 · Slibrary 8 · Sheet 3/4

AI Red-Team Pre-Mortem

Imagine the plan has failed — then let AI argue why

Source (Harvard): Klein, G. (2007) 'Performing a project premortem', Harvard Business Review, 85(9), pp. 18-19.

In one sentence	A team imagines that its plan has already failed, lists the reasons, asks an AI tool to argue further reasons, and then decides which few risks it will actually act on.
About the author(s)	This is the course adaptation by Dr. Hildegard Haas. It builds on Gary Klein, an American research psychologist known for naturalistic decision-making and the recognition-primed decision model, whose books include Sources of Power (1998).
Guiding question (Valcortese Dairy case)	*Assume that Valcortese's recall plan and public statement have failed one month from now: which causes would the team list, which would an AI adversary add, and which three risks would Marco act on before Saturday 12:00?*



F32 · Slibrary 8 · Sheet 4/4

Cynefin × AI Fit

Whether AI helps depends on the domain you are in

Source (Harvard): Snowden, D.J. and Boone, M.E. (2007) 'A leader's framework for decision making', Harvard Business Review, 85(11), pp. 68-76.

In one sentence	The same AI tool can be very useful in one kind of situation and dangerous in another, so leaders should check which Cynefin domain they are in before deciding how far to rely on AI.
About the author(s)	This is the course adaptation by Dr. Hildegard Haas. It builds on Dave Snowden, the Welsh researcher who founded Cognitive Edge (now The Cynefin Company), and Mary E. Boone, consultant and co-author of the 2007 Harvard Business Review article.
Guiding question (Valcortese Dairy case)	*Valcortese's communications agency used AI to draft three statements within hours: in which Cynefin domain was that use a good fit, and where in Marco's crisis should AI only triage while humans decide?*